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APPENDIX 1. SCHEME OF WORK - - - - - - - 26

Abbreviations

AOL: Assessment of Learning.

CPD: Continual Professional Development.

DEIS: Delivering Equality of Opportunity in Schools.

DES: Department of Education and Skills.

NCSE: National Council for Special Education.

NQT: Newly Qualified Teacher.

OECD: Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development.

PME: Professional Masters of Education.

SEN: Special Educational Needs.

TSES: Teachers Sense of Efficacy Scale.

UNESCO: United Nations Educational Scientific and Cultural Organisation.

Chapter 1: Introduction

This dissertation will explore the impact of team-teaching on the teacher identity of a pre-service teacher. There has been limited research done on the benefits of collaborative team teaching yet this teaching approach can prove to be highly effective in improving confidence and building teacher-student relationships. Team teaching can be enjoyable for teachers and students, especially when teaching within mixed ability settings. Plenty of research exists on the benefits of team teaching for SEN teachers, however this dissertation seeks to study the outcomes of team teaching for teachers, as it is based on my own experience.

Since beginning team-teaching last year, I have noticed many differences in the style and manner in which I teach. I have noticed that I am much more relaxed and confident when sharing the classroom with another teacher as opposed to traditional teaching. I have suffered quite a bit with a lack of confidence and self-belief in my teaching abilities since beginning the PME programme. Last year, I returned to my old secondary school to complete my first teaching practice. Although I learned a lot about myself and teaching in general during this time, I struggled to see myself as a 'real teacher'. I did not feel as though I was a teacher at all, I simply felt like a student who was out of place. I was not exposed to any training or opportunities to explore alternative teaching styles. Instead, I was given a book and told to teach the class from the book's beginning until its end. This was not what I expected, nor was I happy with the instructions which I was given. However, I felt as though I was not in a position to argue as I was simply a pre-service teacher. This made me feel completely out of my comfort zone.

In year two of my masters, I knew that I wanted to be in a school which would be vastly different and so I completed my final teaching practice in a small school which had a number of students with behavioural issues and an even mixture of mainstream students as well as

those with SEN. It was in this school in which I was exposed to the idea of team teaching and since then I have noticed my incredible growth in confidence. I have since established my teacher identity and am completely comfortable with the acceptance that I am a professional who has the ability to teach and guide students towards personal and academic growth. Due to my positive experience, team teaching is an area which I would like to research and develop further.

Through team teaching, teachers learn how to naturally integrate critical thinking and team-work into lessons. Personally, team teaching has resulted in inclusion and collaboration within a fun learning environment. "Inclusion means enabling all students to participate fully in the life and work of mainstream settings, whatever their needs" (CSIE, 2002, p.2 cited in NCSE 2010). Indeed, there are numerous ways in which inclusion can be achieved but the one in which I believe achieves the most immediate and dramatic results is the strategy of team teaching.

The results of this paper concludes with practical recommendations as well as directions for further research. In addition, the limitations of this dissertation were also outlined as it is important to highlight the fact that I could only speak from my own experience, and as limited as it may be, it is still insightful and worthy of analysis.

Team teaching is currently in high demand in Post-Primary Irish schools. It is viewed as a promising and worthwhile strategy by both the DES (Circular 02/05) and the OECD (2009). The benefits of team teaching is an area highly worthy of further development by professionals and I think that pre-service teachers in particular should be encouraged to participate in the act of team teaching early in their career as this could help improve confidence and build relationships with students and teachers alike. For these reasons, this dissertation seeks to explore the benefits I have experienced since I began team teaching.

Chapter 2: Literature Review

2.1 Introduction

A literature search was carried out for the purpose of this dissertation. Electronic educational databases such as JSTOR, SAGE, ERIC, and Research Gate were used. Various combinations of key words, such as "team teaching*" OR "cooperative teaching*" AND "achievement" AND "behaviour" were used for the literature search procedure. To ensure the search was relevant, without being too broad, it was limited to published studies from 1970 until 2018. In addition, Google Scholar was also searched.

Research on team teaching has successfully clarified best practices for implementing a relatively new teaching approach within the Irish education system. Inns, Lake, Pellegrini, & Slavin (2009), identified effective programmes for improving literacy levels through a best-evidence synthesis approach study. Their findings highlight the numerous interventions to help struggling readers through various classroom approaches, including team teaching. Inns et. al (2009) suggested that "schools should be encouraged to employ these proven programs in order to help all students achieve reading success" (p.4). This paper highlights the need for schools to invest in evidence based programmes, rather than devoting money towards new ideas and programmes without any knowledge of its potential success rate.

Behaviour and discipline are areas that are prevalent of many studies on the link between team teaching and improving students' behaviour. In a bid to address behavioural issues in the classroom, there has recently been a dramatic rise in the practice of team teaching in Irish classrooms. The UNESCO (2005) also discuss the possible benefits for teachers when approaches such as team teaching are carried out. For the above reasons, team teaching is slowly but surely becoming a well-established and practiced approach within Irish classrooms.

2.2) What is Team Teaching

Team teaching is a term that can vary in meaning due to peoples' differing views on the matter. A particularly insightful view on the approach of team teaching is given as "two or more individuals who come together in a collaborative relationship for the purpose of shared work . . . for the outcome of achieving what none could have done alone" (Wenzlaff, Berak, Wiesman, Monroe-Baillargeon, Bacharach, & Bradfield- Kreider, 2002, p.14). Essentially, team teaching is collaboration between two professionals so that all pupils in the classroom can benefit and learn.

Welch, Brownell, & Sheridan (1999, p.38) defines team teaching "as the simultaneous presence of two educators in a classroom setting who share responsibility in the development, implementation, and evaluation of direct service in the form of an instructional or behavioural intervention to a group of students". This is a very thorough and precise definition and it is on this definition that the following review of literature will be based.

2.3) Factors Required for Successful Team Teaching

Unfortunately, teachers are oftentimes not thought the skills that are required for successful teaching instruction. Darling-Hammond & Sykes (2003) highlight that at least 50,000 teachers in the United States of America each year begin their career without any training. Teacher training must be revised universally in an effort to instil confidence in teachers to tackle the challenges they face when entering the classroom. Going forward, universities need to be proactive if improvements are to be made for our teachers and students.

When evaluating team teaching from an academic viewpoint it can be easy to overlook the significant economic costs of team teaching. Friend & Reising (1993) consider the

requirements from an economic point of view. In order for a school to implement team teaching then - caeteris paribus - the cost of the teaching staff will increase by 100%. In addition to the time that teachers will need to be in the classroom together, they will also need time to plan together.

Murata (2002) conducted a qualitative study within the school she was teaching in, in the US, in a bid to analyse how team teaching informs her colleagues' practice. Her collected data found team teaching to be best practice yet highlighted the need for standard practices to be revisited by high schools. Murata found that finding time to plan as a team was in fact more beneficial than the act of team teaching. She noted that planning as part of a team was beneficial at both a personal and professional level. In order for team teaching to be beneficial for all pupils, it is essential that both teachers co-plan their lessons. If time is not given to co-planning then a limited effectiveness will be achievable. The data Murata collected states that teacher choice, curriculum-driven design, and administrative support are necessary in order for team teaching to be effectively carried out.

It is essential that a positive relationship and mutual understanding of what is expected of students exists amongst professionals carrying out team teaching (Gately & Gately, 2001). Once open and effective communication is achieved, teachers will find planning easier, and team teaching more beneficial and enjoyable for both students and teachers.

2.4) Benefits of Team Teaching

A review of the literature highlights the need for further research into the benefits of team teaching for teachers. Armstrong (1977) found that "little in the research literature provides solace either for team teaching's critics or its most ardent followers" (p. 83). Although four decades have passed since Armstrong's findings, little more has been proven with solid

evidence as the emphasis in the majority of studies to date has focused on the implementation of team teaching rather than the outcomes of team teaching. Despite the lack of evidence, it can be argued that team teaching can decrease teacher's level of stress when planning for and teaching a lesson.

Research by Attwood and Croll (2006) highlights a link between parental expectations of students and behaviour. Their work focused on data from the British Household Panel Survey as well as interviews with a group of frequent truants. They found that most young people admitted that their poor attendance was related to a negative or poor relationship with their teachers. Many stated that they did not go to school regularly because their teacher did not meet their expectations and therefore they did not find school to be beneficial. This study supports my argument that team teaching should be rolled out into mainstream classrooms, as the increase in teachers and improvement in relationships would tackle the issue of attendance and early school leavers.

Many factors can influence the amount and the manner in which students ask for help in the classroom. Team teaching makes it easier for a positive and encouraging atmosphere as well as instils greater teacher-student relationships due to the fact that there is shared responsibility and in effect more time to know and understand your pupils. This makes the act of teaching much more rewarding and worthwhile.

Reay (2005) looks at education through the lens of social class. Within the classroom, bullying occurs due to what Reay calls 'class envy'. Teachers have a pivotal role in improving their pupils' confidence as they aim to encourage and instil a sense of happiness. Reay (2005) discusses the impact of not feeling good enough, she notes how this can interfere with the behaviour of students. Evidence states that negative parental attitudes towards school, alongside a lack of confidence, can result in an advancement in students' behavioural issues (Reay, 2005). In addition, disruptive behaviour and discipline issues can also be seen to be

caused by family circumstances and factors such as low self-esteem, social skills, confidence, and psychological problems, which in turn are more predominantly seen in students from lower class backgrounds (ibid). Reay states that social class can therefore be a "felt injury" (p.916). For these mentioned reasons, research and trials should be carried out to identify if team teaching in mainstream classrooms within disadvantaged areas could improve the behaviour and overall achievements and satisfaction for all pupils.

In conjunction, "in low-income countries, increasing spending to provide more textbooks, reduce class size and improve teacher education and school facilities has a positive impact on learners' cognitive achievement" (UNESCO, 2005, P. 17). Therefore, if more money was invested into schools in low-income areas, the overall benefits and outcomes of strategies such as team teaching could be dramatically evident.

Larson & Goebel (2008) investigated the impact team teaching has on pre-service teachers' sense of achievement in classroom management and student engagement. Students involved in this research were taught by a university professor as well as a high school teacher, both of whom took a collaborative approach to teaching the class. The results on efficacy levels were measured by a pre and post examination of the TSES. Their studies on team teaching have shown an enlargement in teachers' sense of efficacy. The results showed a continuous increase in sense of achievement throughout their participation with the course.

Murawski (2006) conducted a study which found there to be no substantial difference made when team teaching is practiced on students with disabilities. Despite there being no significant change in student achievement, Murawski suggested that team teaching should be considered for the benefits of students' positive experience and engagement with teachers. She highlights the ease to practice active learning which is made possible through the use of team teaching.

Similarly, Packard, Hazelkorn, Harris, & McLeod (2011) carried out a quasi-experimental investigation to study the impact team teaching has on ninth grade students with disabilities. This study showed there was no noteworthy alteration made when pupils were taught by more than one teacher. In this case, those in source classrooms achieved more than those in team teaching settings.

On the other hand, DuFour (2003) found that team teaching classrooms were more successful when compared to non-team teaching classrooms. His study noted the increasingly high demand in which teachers are expected to collaborate with colleagues. DuFour specified that "effective school leaders will…work with staff to create a systematic process in which teachers work together to analyse and impact professional practice to improve their individual and collective results" (p.2). He also noted that the most significant benefits found were an increase in enjoyment of lessons for students in addition to lessons becoming easier to plan and facilitate for teachers.

2.5) Teacher and Student Perceptions of Team Teaching

Keeley (2015) investigated students' views on team teaching by carrying out questionnaires with both teachers and students, in a small subsample of a large urban school in the US. By comparing student responses to teacher responses, this study shows that all teachers and students felt that they positively benefited when team teaching was implemented. Despite the positive views and results gathered, there were various limitations to Keeley's study. The opinions were limited to a rather small number of students, many of whose questionnaires were unreliable sources of evidence as some were receiving special educational services yet were unaware of it. The overall findings were in favour of team teaching; however, it was noted that more research was needed in this specific area of co-teaching (p.14).

Hwang (2002) studied the perception of team teaching among pre-service teachers. Prior to the involved students engaging in team teaching, 80% expressed a negative view towards the use of team teaching, with just 12% expressing an interest in it. Nonetheless, after just one semester of team teaching, a dramatic change in views could be seen. Afterwards, 88% of students reported that they felt the use of team teaching was an effective and positive experience and just 4% of students expressed having a negative experience of team teaching.

Gamsky (1970) carried out a one-year study on the effects of team teaching on attitude and achievement on ninth grade students. 74 students were randomly assigned to a team teaching treatment group while the remainder of the students (71) were assigned a group which received non-team teaching instruction. A teacher built exam measured the individual attitudes and achievements for the purpose of this study. Overall, it was found that team teaching did not impact upon academic growth. Significantly, however, this study did show that team teaching greatly "impacts on student attitudes towards teachers, interest in subject matter, sense of personal freedom, and self-reliance" (p.42). The team teaching students experienced better relationships with their teachers in addition to an increased sense of subject enjoyment when compared to the traditionally taught pupils. Gamsky notes the limitations placed by the small numbers and fixed setting of his study, yet concluded that schools should incorporate team teaching as a strategy for the specific benefits of improving teacher's relationship and trust with their pupils.

2.6) Summary

Kunnari & Auli Toom (2018) looked at team teaching among other innovative pedagogical practices. They used a mixed method of group interviews and individual questionnaires, showing that "the new autonomy of a teacher is socially constructed in collaboration with other teachers" (p.124). Their collected data found that collaboration

improved the teaching and learning as well as the confidence of all involved in this study. The benefits of team teaching was strong as it took "students' needs and colleagues' needs into account" (p.124).

The use of team teaching as a tool for learning can also have implications for classroom management. When properly implemented, team teaching can make it easier for the teacher to use active and engaging methods. Sullivan (2014), argues that rather than focusing your efforts on punishing students for negative behaviour, or rewarding them for positive behaviour, you should instead focus on engaging the students. When students are fully engaged they are less likely to misbehave. This will leave more time throughout the lesson to focus on the teaching and learning, rather than trying to control students. Indeed, this will lower teacher's workload because if students are more receptive and engaged then they will be easier to teach.

The literature clarifies that there is a lack of empirical evidence on the outcomes of team teaching for teachers' benefits. Thus, further studies are needed to investigate the improvements which are possible for teachers in team teaching classrooms.

Chapter 3: Reviewing my practice through the lens of a literature review

3.1) Methods Used

This chapter aims to reflect and compare my experiences from PME Year 1 and PME Year 2 teaching placements. Through the lens of a literature review, I will examine my teaching strategies, the schools' social contexts, and my challenges as well as successes in different lessons. Using my reflections and schemes of work, as well as knowledge that I have gained

through conversation with my colleagues and students, I will evaluate the impact team teaching has had on my profession to date.

Overall, I found that I felt much more at ease entering the classroom with another professional that I could rely on, in turn my mood was excellent and my pupils were engaged in lessons. My second year English class in school B were happier and more involved in active lessons as they had two teachers in every English class with them. Although there are multiple possibilities for this being the case, my experience has shown me that team teaching has played a large role in engaging and involving all pupils in lessons.

3.2) School Context

Both schools in which I completed my teaching practice were DEIS schools, yet I practiced vastly different teaching tactics during each placement. School A was a large mixed-sex school where there were no available resources to engage with team teaching. In my first year of teaching, I found it extremely hard to feel confident in my role as a teacher. The class numbers were approximately thirty and this made it extremely difficult to control a class that had significant behavioural issues, as most had. This of course impacted on my teaching, which in turn felt like a vicious cycle on my confidence and attempt to build and structure my identity as a teacher.

School B is an all-boys school of only one hundred and eighty pupils in total. Although school B has a similarly high level of behavioural issues, the class numbers are small, approximately fourteen, and the school has a large further education section which allows for a significant increase in teacher numbers and allowances. Thankfully, this allows for team teaching to be practiced throughout the school.

3.3) The Benefits of Team Teaching

Team teaching has hugely impacted on myself as a pre-service teacher. I have found that I am generally less stressed when team teaching a lesson and this in turn impacts my students and allows for more active learning to take place. I have gained ample confidence through team teaching my students and as a result, active learning strategies are more deeply integrated into my teaching.

Appendix 1 refers to my most recent lessons in which I was consciously aware of the need for another teacher, and myself, to be involved in the delivery and facilitation of classes. I delivered a unit of poetry by Eiléan Ní Chuilleanáin while integrating active learning into the classroom. I found it difficult to engage the class and as students' difficulties and behavioural issues increased, I sought to address and minimise the problems through my prior knowledge and experiences of the benefits of team teaching. Overall, the strategy was successful as all students were kept on track and engaged in class. In addition, I greatly benefited from this experience as I felt a growth in confidence as well as an improvement in mutual respect among my students and myself. This, in effect, helped me in my ongoing shaping and acceptance of my teacher identity.

The increased amount of active learning leads to students becoming more engaged in the classroom and as a result behavioural difficulties are less likely to arise. Furthermore, my students' perceptions of team teaching also helps as they are generally more receptive and engaged thus they are easier to teach. According to one of my second year pupils, it is "better to have two teachers because more people can get help and then students don't feel left out when asking for the teacher". Another student added to this by noting that more work is done as more help is available and in effect this makes him feel supported and confident in his learning.

I have found that there needs to be a reason teachers collaborate. Team teaching should be making a positive difference for the students and the teachers, it should be enjoyed and helpful otherwise there would be no point in investing time in to it.

Chapter 4: Conclusion

4.1) The Practitioner-Researcher

Learning to become a reflective practitioner has allowed me to progress and evolve as a teacher. This has impacted greatly on my practice and has made me a confident teacher. To become a reflective practitioner, one must be open to deep analysis and criticisms. As a teacher, we have a responsibility to constantly be helping our pupils grow and achieve more. Through examination of my own practice, I always try to critique my logic for each way that I teach, this then makes it easier for me to view the consequences and advances due to each strategy used.

The evidence in my literature review is supported by my reflections (see Appendix 1) in that I have experienced a growth in my confidence, improved relationships and indeed an increase in engagement and positive behaviour on the pupils' behalf. Undoubtedly, this results in the teaching of each lesson much smoother and of course more enjoyable for all involved. Murawski (2006) states that team teaching allows for more hands on activities and approaches to be used. This was reflected in my lesson from appendix 1, when I noted my difficulties in my first week of a three-week scheme of work on a unit of poetry by Eiléan Ní Chuilleanáin. I found it difficult to get the class to settle down and begin their work which I had assigned through the use of iPads. My current school in which I am teaching is small and we have only sixteen iPads which means that our students are not used to having iPads in class, therefore

many students have difficulties navigating apps and completing activities at a quick rate. Due to the large number of students in this class, it took too much time for me to help all pupils who were having issues with the iPads. I was certain that the use of team teaching would be beneficial for this particular group and so with thanks to my cooperating teacher the following class was taught through team teaching. Immediately, I could see the difference being made as the class were settled down and setting themselves up on the iPads so that we could begin online polls and quizzes. The additional support and guidance another teacher allows for can make a significant change in the number of learning intentions achievable for any particular class group.

4.2) Findings

My confidence in my teaching abilities have greatly improved since becoming involved in team teaching. Through this strategy, I have discovered a lot about the strengths of myself, my colleagues, and my students.

The idea that team teaching allows for more hands-on activities and approaches to be used (Murawski, 2006) is evident in my own experiences with team teaching. Having another teacher's help and support during a lesson eases the worry of trying out new activities and approaches. For example, when using iPads or other forms of technology in a lesson, it is comforting knowing that there is another teacher there to explain and help the pupils settle down so class can begin. Teaching through collaboration gives teachers confidence to try new things and be more creative with methodologies. I have found that I am always more relaxed and confident when teaching alongside someone else. The lessons that I team teach are consistently more fun and engaging for both students and teacher and I believe that this is because there is another teacher in the room with me. Team teaching is good for the wellbeing

of teachers as I have always felt less stress and pressure is on me when I am supported and confident in my role.

Life is easier and more pleasant if we are lucky enough to enjoy the company of our colleagues (DuFour, 2003). Through reflecting upon my own teaching, this is something which resonates clearly with me. Comparing my experiences from PME Year 1 and PME Year 2, my professional enjoyment as well as my teacher identity have evolved leaps and bounds through collaborative teaching and learning. Through analysing my reflections from team taught and non-team taught lessons, there is a clear difference in my overall thoughts on the successfulness of each class. I have found that I am more content in my objectives after team teaching and this improves my growth in confidence as a teacher.

My own students' views on team teaching is that it is fairer on students because if one teacher is in a bad mood or arguing with one pupil then this usually results in the teacher taking their unhappy humor out on the whole class. My reflections echo this as I have found it to be extremely hard to go through nine class periods without carrying a bad mood over to a new class, despite all efforts made. This negative impact can cause serious problems between teachers and all students. However, when two teachers are in the room then it is more likely that the tone and atmosphere throughout the class will be lifted. My views are in line with the thoughts of my students, as one insists that having two teachers giving instructions is always more of a laugh and this makes him want to come to school, especially for the classes where he is taught through team teaching. It is more likely that positive relationships will evolve within classroom settings when there is more support and help at hand. By having two English teachers rather than one, my students tend to find it easier to communicate and trust in one of their teachers. This is supported by my PME year 2 reflections as they show that there is always a positive atmosphere and learning environment present.

My colleagues have observed some of my team teaching classes and have commented on the legitimate benefits and clear need to have this strategy tested and then rolled out across classrooms where mainstream teachers are given the opportunity to engage in training for team teaching.

4.3) Conclusion

In conclusion, the impact of team-teaching on the teacher identity of a pre-service teacher can be seen to raise confidence and belief in themselves as professionals. Team teaching helped me to build confidence, and this is supported by the literature (Reay, 2005 & Kunnari & Auli Toom, 2018).

Attwood & Croll's study (2006) highlighted the link between poor attendance and a negative or poor relationship with their teachers. My findings correlate with this piece of literature as my students have, in conversation, suggested that they are much more willing to come to their team taught classes as they find them more enjoyable and worthwhile. Indeed, team teaching can be challenging at the beginning however, once best practice has been found, alongside regularly scheduled time to plan, there is a rewarding and doubly positive gratitude to be found. My students enjoy having two teachers in a room with them, they feel as though it is much fairer as they learn more. The comments made in conversation with my pupils and I make me feel like a successful teacher. It is comforting to know that team teaching has improved not only my confidence, but also theirs.

My findings of significant increases in enjoyment levels due to team teaching is reflected in the literature of DuFour (2003) as he mentions how the act of working together as a team can result in improved enjoyment for all involved.

4.4) Challenges

Unfortunately, not all schools have the teacher numbers nor the funds required to successfully team teach throughout the school. I have been lucky so far to have had the opportunity to engage in different teaching strategies so early on in my career.

From examining my reflections, it was often difficult to assess the true extent of the outcomes of team teaching. It takes time to master the art of team teaching, and even more time to start noticing the improvements being made. Nonetheless, on a personal level, I have greatly benefited through the act of team teaching. It has helped me to see myself as a leader who is capable of moving pupils of all abilities forward in their learning.

Although experiences and views of team teaching may differ for others, I have a positive view of its usefulness for teachers and my experience is backed up by the literature. However, I am aware of the limitations and the fact that the outcomes I achieved through team teaching might not be the same for everyone. I found that team teaching works very well yet this is only the experience I was exposed to, also, the literature which strengthens my argument is only a small selection of papers.

Overall, there are strengths and limitations which can be seen from my reflections. My data shows only one perspective, which is mine, and it is therefore biased. However, there is also strength in this because I have an understanding of all of my pupils in addition to a positive relationship with them, therefore, I witness the impact and difference my methodologies make on my teaching and in effect my students' learning.

4.5) Recommendations for practice

In order for team teaming to successfully grow, there needs to be an emphasis put on the need for additional funding. With extra funding it would be possible to increase teacher

numbers, therefore the possibility of team teaching becoming more commonly used could rise dramatically.

This researcher recommends CPD training on team teaching to be offered to all teachers. The use of team teaching in mainstream classrooms could see, if effectively carried out, overall great improvements for all students and teachers involved with the strategy. Initially it is an idea that would terrify most pre-service teachers and NQTs, but with support and CPD training the benefits and results will alter most peoples' opinions.

It is important that team teachers find time to plan together (Murata, 2002). Furthermore, it is essential that they plan time to review students' progress on a weekly basis. This does not have to be a substantial amount of extra work for teachers. One simple yet effective way could be that teachers find five minutes at the end of the week to sit down together, call out student names from the roll book and simply give a thumbs up or thumbs down with regards to the progress being made, academically and personally due to efforts made and any possible behavioural concerns. A mark is placed beside the name of students that gets a thumbs down by any one teacher. If one teacher displays a sideways thumb, then a question mark would be placed beside that student's name. Ultimately, this saves a lot of time and cuts out irrelevant discussions.

4.6) Possibilities for further research

More research into the implications of team teaching within the mainstream classroom is needed. Team teaching has correlated with improving attitudes, behaviours and achievements of teachers and in effect their students (DuFour, 2003; Keeley, 2015; Gamsky, 1970; Kunnari & Auli Toom, 2018; Sullivan, 2014), however, more evidence, on a larger scale,

is needed before schools invest and implement this type of instruction as a whole school approach.

Further to this, additional research would improve McDuffie, Mastropieri, & Scruggs' (2009) argument that "students in co-taught settings statistically outperformed students in non-co-taught settings" (p.506). If this could be seen by teachers with their own pupils then it would bring about a positive and rewarding sense of achievement for the efforts made on the teacher's behalf.

Additional research into team teaching's effects on teachers should be carried out in primary schools, post-primary schools, as well as at higher education levels. Team teaching studies should be carried out across all subject areas so that its effectiveness on each subject teacher can be determined. I would also recommend that any university involved in teacher education should include team teaching into their methodologies module (Darling-Hammond & Sykes, 2003).

This research is limited to my experience, but I believe that if information and training was given to teachers then there would be more of a willingness to try new strategies, and it will only be then when multiple experiences and evidence based work can be achieved and shared.

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Appendix 1

Scheme of Work

Topic/Unit Plan of Work (PME Year 2)

Subject	English
Class/Year	5th Year
Planning Period	15th March- 13th April 2018
Number of Lessons	6
Topic/Unit/Theme	Poetry – EILÉAN NÍ CHUILLEANÁIN

Learning Outcomes

Students will learn to:

1. Listen actively in order to interpret meaning, compare, evaluate effectiveness of, and respond to drama, poetry, media broadcasts, digital media, noting key ideas, style, tone, content and overall impact in a systematic way.
2. Read texts with fluency, understanding and competence, decoding groups of words/phrases and not just single words.
3. Respond imaginatively in writing to their texts showing a critical appreciation of language, style and content, choice of words, language patterns, tone, images.

Learning Intentions

Students will:

1. Develop an understanding of the life of Ni Chuilleanain's.
2. Learn three of Ni Chuilleanain's poems (To Niall Woods… , Street, The Bend in the Road).
3. Discuss the themes and issues in Ni Chuilleanain's poetry.
4. To respond creatively in writing to poetry.

Assessment Strategies

Formative:

- Pair/Group work
- Discussion
- Oral presentation
- Oral and written questioning in class
- Peer questioning in class
- Classwork and Homework activities- written, research and projects
- Think-Pair-Share
- Debates
-

Summative:

- Easter exam
- End of topic exam

Resources

- PowerPoint presentations
- Videos
- Handouts
- YouTube
- Photos
- Mind maps

Weekly Reflections	
Week 1 (15th-16th March 2018)	I am unhappy at the stage we are at in the course work, we still have plenty of the course to cover and only have a maximum of 7 weeks to do so. Despite being behind and stuck for time, I cannot and will not rush through the course work- my fifth years are a low ability class and they find processing a lot of information quite difficult. This is why I have being going very slowly through the course. Hopefully, with great encouragement and determination we will manage to finish the remaining sections while learning plenty in the process. However, it is proving to be very difficult to motivate the students. Very few students are completing homework to an appropriate standard and I am finding that I don't have enough time to be spending with helping all students who are struggling or perhaps need the added encouragement to get their work done.
Week 2 (22nd-23rd March 2018)	It was difficult to get the class settled and working this week due to a number of behavioural issues. This class is large in numbers, 22 students in total, which is the biggest subject class throughout the school. I'm certain that team teaching would greatly benefit these students as the class is so big and there is such a huge difference in abilities that another teacher is essential. Based on my experiences with team teaching other classes, I have seen the benefits and improvements which can be made with the aid of new and mixed teaching strategies. I am planning on talking to my co-operating teacher about this as she is also unhappy with the low level of teaching and learning within this class group.
Week 3 (12th-13th April 2018)	This has been the most positive and engaged week for my students. I spoke to my co-operating teacher and we discussed future possibilities and strategies for helping our students' learning needs. After explaining how certain I was that the use of team teaching would be beneficial for this particular group, my cooperating teacher and myself ensured that the following class was taught through team teaching. After some difficulty with planning and timetable issues, we were allowed to team teach the 5th years. Immediately, I could see the difference being made as the class were settled down and setting themselves up and beginning work. Suddenly, the students were asking questions and thinking in depth about our coursework. The additional support and guidance another teacher allowed for made a significant change in the attitude of the class as a whole. The students felt as though they were been fairly listened to and the added attention that they experienced really made a difference with their eagerness and motivation in class.